# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Saul D. Bid

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Saul D. Bid**

## *Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House*

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of **Hugh Bidder**.
- Knows **Ella Gance** and **Elon Mosaic** from the auction circuit.
- **Anya Tique** remembers when Saul was still carrying catalogs for someone else.

### ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Saul D. Bid. Going once, going twice—no, I am only asking someone to pass the bread.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Behind the portrait

## Your stake tonight

Rivalry with Hugh consumes the dignity he thinks distinguishes his profession from hustling.

## During the investigation

Everyone has something to hide. Your printed account may protect a personal secret. Read your selected box as written; do not invent events, witnesses or evidence.

## Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Saul D. Bid**

# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *A screen steals every eye. The evidence has slipped out of view behind it.*

**2** *The award has already been won. Its underside offers another reward.*

**3** *The clue is keeping company with the lamp in green.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Grant placed Hugh's valuation beneath my house's name. I withdrew the comparison. I had accepted an advisory fee, so this was an expensive disagreement to make graciously. Hugh and I have known each other a long time. I can recall his bad sales without consulting a file. I would prefer not to know quite so clearly how much pleasure that gives me.

## IF MURDERER

> Grant circulated Hugh's valuation beneath my house's name. I had accepted an advisory fee. He could require me to defend the price and return the fee before my own clients. I withdrew the comparison. Hugh and I have known each other a long time. Being made to answer for his transaction was a humiliation Grant understood perfectly well before arranging it.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I withdrew the disputed bowl from the proposed charity sale. Marked the bottle not for sale; it was a museum loan. Both objects stayed. I attended the preview and told collectors the list was changing. Hugh could defend his price without borrowing my sale room. I meant him to hear that. I was enjoying the announcement more than I ought to have been.

## IF MURDERER

I withdrew the bowl from the proposed sale and marked the bottle not for sale. At the preview I told the collectors the list was changing. Later I took the revised list to Grant's private place. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I set the list down and waited. Hugh, your price could stand on your own firm's name. Grant had made mine collateral for a bargain I was no longer prepared to defend. That was the conversation I meant to have.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The loans remained on their supports. My staff stopped offering them for sale. I returned the advisory fee on the disputed lot. Hugh, I expected you to take that personally. You did. I had prepared a rather elegant reply for when you complained about it. I find I no longer want to hear myself deliver it.

## IF MURDERER

> Intake removed the bottle before the collectors entered. Its card stayed beside the painting. My withdrawal was carried out physically. The fee settlement addressed a separate matter. Hugh, I expected you to take that personally. You did. Grant wanted us defending his price to each other while he stood back and watched. I had finished providing that entertainment.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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Saul D. Bid

# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## Your character name

## I accuse

## Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Saul D. Bid**

# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The sale withdrawal did not remove the physical loan; the photograph shows it remained. I returned the fee. Hugh, I enjoyed your embarrassment. It was shabby of me. I can apologize for that without endorsing your certificate or asking you to accept mine. We have enough clients to disappoint without inventing another rivalry to feed them.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. I withdrew the sale offer, not the bottle. It was there at the preview, where I took its poison. I later used his waiting glass. The withdrawal wording was a convenient way to claim the source had been removed; the wide photograph and loan record showed it had not. I had put my house's authority behind advice I did not want examined. Hugh, you may keep the last word. I have made every future sale beneath my house's name a question about what I did tonight.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*